

Property Inspections Policy

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1. Purpose and Scope

Regular property inspections allow DataCompany to fulfil its maintenance obligations, identify early signs of disrepair, verify that properties are being occupied in accordance with the Tenancy Agreement, and protect the long-term value of the housing portfolio. This policy applies to all residential properties managed by DataCompany and all named tenants.

2. Types of Inspection

Inspection Type	Purpose	Frequency	Notice Given
Pre-Tenancy Inspection	Establish baseline property condition before tenant moves in	Once, before occupation	N/A
Routine Periodic Inspection	Check condition, identify maintenance needs, verify tenancy compliance	Every 6 months	Minimum 7 days written notice
Follow-Up Inspection	Verify that repairs have been completed or previously noted issues resolved	As required	Minimum 48 hours notice
End-of-Tenancy Inspection	Comprehensive condition check and deposit assessment	Once, after tenant vacates	Arranged with tenant
Emergency Inspection	Response to urgent safety concern, flood, fire or structural risk	As required	Minimum practicable notice or immediate if safety risk
Annual Safety Inspection	Gas safety, smoke detectors, electrical checks per legal requirements	Annual	Minimum 7 days written notice

3. Notice of Inspections

DataCompany will always provide written notice of any planned inspection. Notice is issued via the tenant portal, email or registered letter and includes the date, approximate time window (minimum 2-hour slot), name of the inspector, and purpose of the visit. Tenants may request a change of date for routine inspections, provided an alternative date within 10 working days is agreed.

In emergency situations, DataCompany may enter a property without prior notice to prevent damage, injury or loss. In such cases, the tenant will be informed as quickly as practicable and a full written record of the visit will be provided within 24 hours.

4. What is Inspected

4.1 Internal Areas

- Condition of ceilings, walls, floors and internal doors.
- Kitchen condition including units, worktops, taps and drainage.
- Bathroom and toilet condition including sanitaryware, tiling, ventilation and drainage.
- Condition of all DataCompany-provided fixtures, fittings and appliances.
- Smoke and carbon monoxide detectors: presence, condition and operability.
- Evidence of damp, condensation or mould and its likely cause.
- General cleanliness and hygiene consistent with tenancy obligations.
- Any visible signs of unauthorised alterations, additions or damage.

4.2 External Areas (where applicable)

- Front and rear garden areas: maintenance, waste, overgrowth.
- External walls, windows, roof gutters and drainage (visible from ground level).
- Parking area and storage (bins, sheds) for appropriate use and condition.
- Communal areas: cleanliness, signage, lighting and security fixtures.

5. Inspection Reports

A written inspection report is completed for every property visit. The report is added to the tenancy file and a copy is provided to the tenant within 5 working days of the inspection. Where issues are identified, the report will specify: the nature of the issue, whether it is the responsibility of DataCompany or the tenant, the required action, and the timescale for resolution.

6. Tenant Access Obligations

Tenants are required to provide reasonable access for inspections at the agreed date and time. Where a tenant fails to allow access on two consecutive occasions without valid reason, DataCompany may apply for a legal order to permit entry. Repeated refusal without good cause constitutes a breach of the Tenancy Agreement and may be grounds for tenancy action.

Tenants who need to arrange access through a representative (friend or family) must notify DataCompany in advance in writing. The representative must present identification on arrival and will be required to sign an access log.

7. Findings and Follow-Up Actions

Finding Category	Example	Follow-Up Action
DataCompany Maintenance Required	Leaking pipe, defective window seal	Job raised on maintenance system; tenant notified of repair schedule
Tenant Action Required	Condensation due to insufficient ventilation, minor cleaning standard	Written advisory issued; re-inspection within 30 days

Tenancy Breach	Unauthorised occupant, subletting, illegal modifications	Formal notice under Tenancy Agreement; potential legal action
Safety Hazard	Faulty appliance, blocked fire exit, dangerous electrical installation	Immediate action required; tenancy enforcement if tenant-caused
No Issues Found	Property in good order	Report filed; next inspection scheduled